

the features of smart tags in Word XP.) When you point the mouse a thunder-like symbol is shown, which when pointed to gives you the options of undoing the changes made, stop making similar changes, or launch the Autocorrection settings. This way you can control the way your software changes the words you type. When the blue box appears you could also press [Alt] +

[Shift] + [F10] to launch the smart tag menu.

 Random selection

With the earlier versions of Word you were not allowed to select words that were non-contiguous. With the latest version you can select words and text randomly in a document.

While selecting text which is spread

all over the document, press the [Ctrl] key. This will allow you to select all the text of your choice at one go, even when it is non-contiguous.

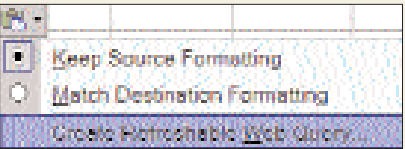
Click the first word to be selected as you would do it normally. The next selection could be made by pressing the [Ctrl] key to make random selections. This is highly useful when you want to reformat words.

EXCEL XP

Master Excel XP with its new features for refreshable queries, organising and repairing files. Make Excel your personal assistant with the new conversion and speech processing features

 Online updates

You have copied some values from the Web onto your Excel sheet for some analysis. Your analysis has to stay current with the data on the Web site. Wouldn't



Create refreshable queries for updates

it be easier to have the software do the updates for you time and again in the background? Excel XP has the facility to do so. Copy the table from the Web onto an Excel sheet. For example, choose some data from Reuters or any other financial portal. Paste it onto the Excel sheet. A smart tag appears next to the



Select the tabel for updation

pasted table. Click the smart tag and choose Create Refreshable Web Query. It opens a pop-up window where you can select tables from the Web page, which would also update the data on the Excel sheet. Click the Import button to import all data immediately. You have a choice to automatically refresh the data or do it manually from the View > Tools bar > External data option.

 Cross checking

After you have entered a whole lot of data all by yourself, you might need to recheck it. And rechecking the data with the onscreen version can be a pain. Don't panic. Excel XP has the facility to read out data. Choose Speech from the tools menu and click on the Show Text to Speech Toolbar option. On the Speech toolbar, click the Play button and the reader starts reading the data row-wise, starting from row one. You can change the settings to read column-wise also by clicking the appropriate button on the Speech toolbar.

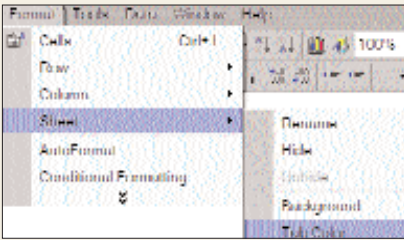
 Easy access to new AutoSum functions

The earlier version of Excel had all the Autosum features handy, but they were limited. Excel XP has the Autosum button linked to a lengthier list of functions, which can be added to your worksheet in a jiffy. You can quickly calculate the

average of selected cells, maximum or minimum value, and much more with these new and powerful functions. Just click on the arrow next to the Autosum symbol for access to all the functions.

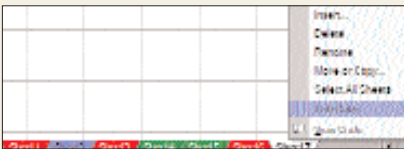
 Stay organised

We would generally like to organise data in a way that's easily accessible. This is



Choose tab colours for sheets

why we use tools such as Excel and other spreadsheets. Excel XP has a new, helpful feature by which you can colour code sheets with related data in one colour. Right-click the sheet and select Tab colour. When the colour window pops up, choose the required colour and click OK. You could press [Ctrl], select all the



Changing tab colour by right-clicking tabs

Ad will come